

If this all sounds rather hopeless, then please don't worry – the aim of this book is to teach you how to navigate the internal factors while acknowledging the external ones, hopefully without making you feel judged, patronized or infantilized. Because this is the other issue with mainstream financial advice and information – it can be far too basic and numbers based, leaving us with a notebook full of sums and a mind full of worry.

Internal factors, external forces and the relationship between them

I thought for a long time about how to write a book that could inspire individual positive action without ignoring the fact that not everything is always under our personal control. For so many people, determination to take responsibility for every single thing that's gone wrong (or right) acts as a barrier to real change or even happiness. There is absolutely no point in accepting responsibility or blame for an issue that is simply not your fault, in the same way that it doesn't do you any favours to take credit for something that wasn't the result of your own efforts. If you have been paid very poorly, been the victim of a scam or financial abuse, been born into a family without wealth privilege or precedent, been discriminated against or experienced any number of other systemic injustices, that is not something for which you should be accepting responsibility. You can only change the things that are within your control, and that is what my five steps focus on, but you must always,